THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · NCERT-TYPE CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Colonialism is the practice in which one country 1

(a) helps another grow
(b) takes control of another region and imposes its systems
(c) shares its land
(d) trades equally with another

2. The French founded Pondicherry in 1

(a) 1757 **(b)** 1498 **(c)** 1674 **(d)** 1600

3. Which Governor-General introduced the Doctrine of Lapse? 1

(a) Bentinck **(b)** Clive **(c)** Wellesley **(d)** Dalhousie

4. The 'Age of Colonialism' refers to the expansion of Europe from the 1

(a) 15th century onwards **(b)** 10th century
(c) 20th century only **(d)** 5th century

5. Dupleix is known for 1

(a) founding Calcutta
(b) training Indian soldiers and backing puppet rulers
(c) writing laws
(d) defeating Clive

6. The Bengal famine of 1770 killed about 1

(a) 90% **(b)** one-third of Bengal's population
(c) none **(d)** 1% of the population

7. Which was NOT a reason for European colonisation? 1

(a) Spread of Indian philosophy **(b)** Search for wealth
(c) New markets **(d)** Political rivalry

8. The Carnatic Wars were fought between 1

(a) the Dutch and Portuguese **(b)** Marathas and Mughals
(c) the French and the British **(d)** Sikhs and British

9. The Great Famine of 1876-78 occurred under Viceroy 1

(a) Lord Ripon **(b)** Lord Lytton **(c)** Lord Curzon **(d)** Lord Mayo

10. Until the 16th century India contributed about what share of world GDP? 1

(a) One-tenth **(b)** Half **(c)** One-fourth **(d)** One-hundredth

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Define colonialism. 2

12. Why is Colachel important? 2

13. State two causes of the 1770 Bengal famine. 2

14. State two reasons for European colonisation. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. List the reasons why Europeans were attracted to India. 3

16. What was the role of Mir Jafar in the Battle of Plassey? 3

17. How did colonial rule change education? 3

OR

Describe the Portuguese in India. 3

18. Compare the Doctrine of Lapse and Subsidiary Alliance. 3

OR

Why were railways not a gift to Indians? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain colonialism and the reasons for European colonisation. 5

OR

Describe changes in governance and education under colonial rule. 5

20. Describe the Portuguese, Dutch and French in India. 5

OR

Describe early resistance: Sannyasi-Fakir, tribal revolts, Indigo. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

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